

FLASH EUROBAROMETER 566 • CONSUMER INSIGHTS READ

Trust, but verify.

Europe's energy transition runs on consumers —
and consumers are ambivalent.

18,250

EU citizens who make their household's energy decisions, surveyed across all 27 member states (June–July 2025).

THE PREMISE

The transition depends on behaviour. So belief is the story.

Clean-energy policy assumes people will switch providers, shift usage, and adopt new tech. Whether they do hinges less on the technology than on whether they trust the system asking them to change. This survey measures that trust — and finds it uneven.

18,250

Decision-makers surveyed

EU27

All member states

CATI

Telephone, RDD sample

±1.0%

Margin at EU level

THE CENTRAL FINDING

Europeans trust their provider — but not the market it sits in.

79%

trust their own electricity / gas provider

13-point
credibility gap

66%

trust the national energy market

Loyalty is personal; skepticism is systemic. People extend credit to the company that bills them, while doubting the market around it. A provider can win precisely where the category is failing.

You can't act on what you can't read.

If the transition needs people to monitor and adjust, comprehension is the first barrier. Most understand the basics — but a large minority don't, and clarity is among the top fixes consumers ask for.

Only ~1 in 3 fully understand every part of their bill (Q6).



High demand for protection. Low sense of recourse.

40%

want better protection for vulnerable & energy-poor consumers — the #1 requested fix

39%

don't know which authority to turn to in a dispute

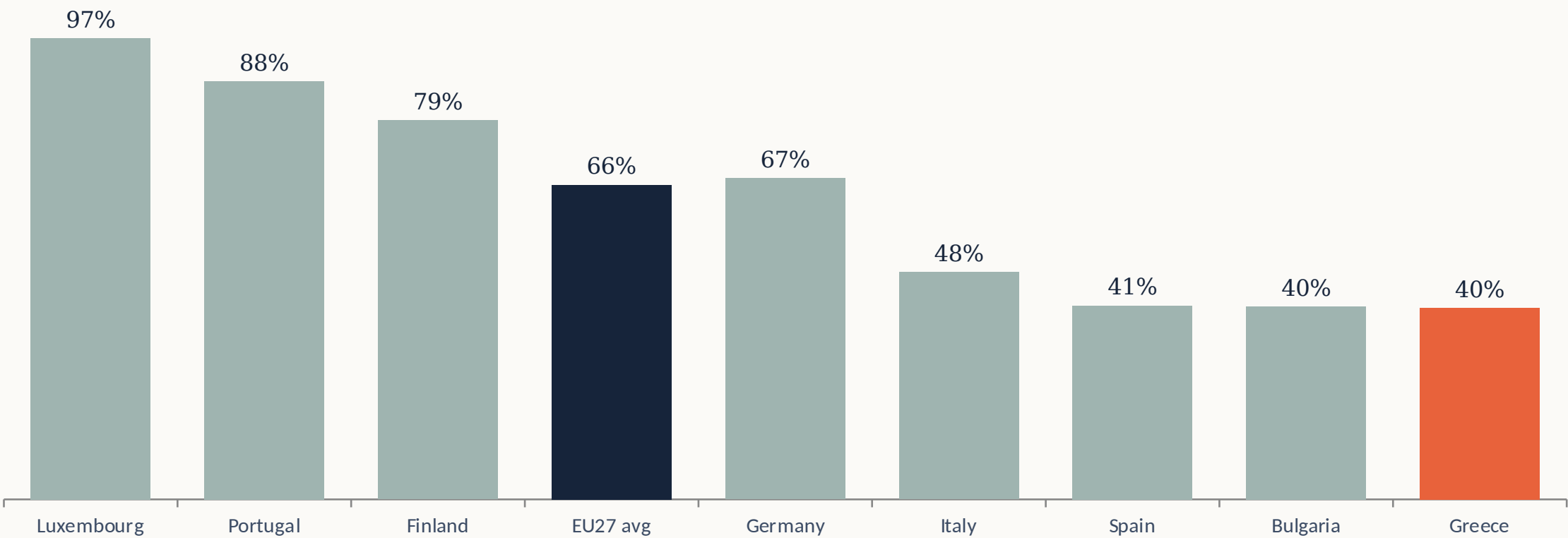
82%

would trust a provider more if it were certified on consumer rights

The unmet need is concrete and service-shaped: clearer rights, visible recourse, credible certification.

The paradox is sharpest in the South.

Market trust isn't evenly felt. A clear core-periphery split runs through Europe — and Greece trusts its energy market least of all 27 nations.



Q1_1 market trust, weighted, by country. Selected nations shown; EU27 average for reference.

Three moves the data points to.

01 Win on transparency

The provider-market gap is an opening: clear bills and honest offers convert distrust into loyalty where the category can't.

02 Make recourse visible

Two in five don't know where to turn. Signposting rights and disputes is low-cost and directly addresses the protection gap.

03 Certify to earn trust

82% would trust a certified provider more. A credible code of practice is among the cheapest trust levers available.

How this was built.

Source. Flash Eurobarometer 566, 'Consumer Behaviour in the Energy Transition' (European Commission / GESIS ZA9118; doi.org/10.4232/1.14763). Fieldwork 30 Jun–15 Jul 2025, EU27, CATI.

Base. 18,250 EU citizens involved in household energy decisions (excl. those whose price is fixed in rent with no opt-out). Reproduced from microdata: n=18,247.

Method. Post-stratification weight (w1) applied to all figures; percentages computed over full base including 'Don't know', matching the Commission's convention. Analysis in Python + SQL (SQLite); figures verified against the official report (provider trust 78.9% vs published 79%).

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